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NEWSPAPER

11th December, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

50th WEEK



SOUTH AFRICA...CORRUPTION

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

11th DECEMBER, 2017

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South Africa's ANC must seize the chance to pull away from the Zuma cabal

This month South Africa will have a rare opportunity to break away from the difficult political legacy of corruption and governance failures that have blighted its post-apartheid years. At a conference during December 16-20, the African National Congress will pick its candidate for party leader, and that person will go on to replace 10-year incumbent President Jacob Zuma. Whoever Mr. Zuma hands over the reins of power to will be the favourite to become the country's next President in 2019. But he or she will also inherit a troubled political system and a nervous, gloomy economy. Staggering unemployment, now nearly reaching 28%, has been the chief characteristic of what some describe as Mr. Zuma's "second hidden decade" at the helm of the ANC. This has been, by most accounts, a period during which allegations of grand corruption and cronyism multiplied exponentially. Promising to root out this pervasive rot in institutional quality is one of two leading candidates: Deputy President Cyril Ramaphosa, a policy centrist and firm member of the party's constitutionalist wing. The other serious candidate in the reckoning is Nkosinathi Dlamini Zuma, Mr. Zuma's ex-wife, who was a minister in his several cabinets and chair of the African Union.

Ms. Dlamini-Zuma, if she prevails, is expected to muddy the prospects of any investigation into alleged murky financial dealings between Mr. Zuma's son and three brothers of the wealthy, Indian-origin Gupta family of South Africa, owners of a massive business conglomerate that controls stakes in the computer equipment, metals and mining industries. She is also expected to be the candidate of continuity inasmuch as she will echo Mr. Zuma's call for "radical economic transformation" and continue policies that are ostensibly aimed at redistributing control of resources to the nation's relatively impoverished black majority. Either way, her nomination will boost the forces of "state capture" or economic rent-seeking built on the militarisation of the South African state itself. Already, there are 783 counts of corruption relating to a 1999 arms deal pending against Mr. Zuma, yet no charges have been pressed. Similarly, despite reams of evidence against the Guphas in a report by a former Public Prosecutor, no enforcement action has been forthcoming. According to Pravin Gordhan, who was fired as Finance Minister in March 2017, about \$3 billion "has been looted" owing to undue influence of private interests over public institutions. For even if Mr. Ramaphosa wins, the party continues, the motives of the ANC may be far from pure. With its overall popularity sliding, the party will have to work hard to bring in the next generation of leaders, with a greater political stature, if it wishes to realise a greater collective destiny for South Africa.

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THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :11th December, 2017

South Africa's ANC must seize the chance to pull away from the Zuma cabal

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SOUTH AFRICA



NAMIBIA

ZIMBABWE

MOZAMBIQUE

MADAGASCAR

BOTSWANA

Pretoria (executive)

SWAZILAND

Bloemfontein (judicial)

SOUTH AFRICA

LESOTHO

SOUTH ATLANTIC OCEAN

INDIAN OCEAN

Cape Town (legislative)

ABOUT SOUTH AFRICA**NELSON MANDELA**

Former President, South Africa

- 1** It is the southern most country in Africa and has coastline towards both Atlantic and Indian Oceans.
- 2** The population is around 55 million.
- 3** There are 11 official languages.
- 4** Executive Capital is Pretoria, Judicial Capital is Bloemfontein, Legislative Capital is Cape Town.
- 5** GDP is around \$750 billion (on PPP Basis).
- 6** Nelson Mandela became the first African President of South Africa.

ERA OF JACOB ZUMA**JACOB ZUMA**

President, South Africa

- 1 Unemployment is touching 28%.
- 2 Mr.Zuma's tenure is ridden with scandals.
- 3 There are allegations of corruption and cronyism.
- 4 Already, there are 783 counts / charges of corruption relating to 1999 arms deal pending against M.Zuma.
- 5 There are alleged financial dealings between Zuma's son and three brothers with Indian origin family of South Africa.

It is the time that South Africa should bring the next generation of leaders with a greater political stature, If it wishes to realize a greater collective destiny for South Africa.

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